HIRING ON A $0 SOFTWARE BUDGET

# 6 paid hiring tools you can swap for free ones

All open source. Use the free hosted version or run it yourself.

~~Greenhouse · Lever · Workable~~

~~Calendly~~

~~Zoom~~

~~Typeform~~

~~DocuSign~~

~~Paid AI screening tools~~

SWAP 1 OF 6 · APPLICANT TRACKING

~~Greenhouse · Lever · Workable~~

↓

# Frappe HR

open source

★ 9,020 stars

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Job openings and hiring plans
- ✓ Applicants tagged by source: referral, website, campaign
- ✓ Interview rounds with feedback from each interviewer
- ✓ Offer letters, then one click to make them an employee

THE CATCH

It's a full HR and payroll system, so give it an afternoon to set up.

github.com/frappe/hrms

SWAP 2 OF 6 · INTERVIEW SCHEDULING

~~Calendly~~

↓

# Cal.com

open source

★ 49,714 stars

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ A booking page connected to your calendar
- ✓ Candidates pick their own slot
- ✓ Reminders go out automatically

THE CATCH

Running it yourself needs a server. The hosted version is the quick start.

`github.com/calcom/cal.diy`

SWAP 3 OF 6 · VIDEO INTERVIEWS

~~Zoom~~

↓

# Jitsi Meet

open source ★ 30,203 stars

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Interviews from a link
- ✓ Works in the browser
- ✓ No account needed for the candidate

THE CATCH

On the public meet.jit.si service the host signs in. Self-host it for full control.

github.com/jitsi/jitsi-meet

SWAP 4 OF 6 · APPLICATION FORMS

~~Typeform~~

↓

# Formbricks

open source

★ 13,217 stars

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Application forms
- ✓ A few screening questions
- ✓ All responses in one place

THE CATCH

It's built as a survey tool. It gives you forms, not a full careers page.

github.com/formbricks/formbricks

SWAP 5 OF 6 · OFFER LETTERS

~~DocuSign~~

↓

# Documenso

open source ★ 15,665 stars

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Send offer letters for e-signature
- ✓ Reusable templates
- ✓ A signing record for every document

THE CATCH

Check your country's e-signature rules for employment contracts first.

github.com/documenso/documenso

SWAP 6 OF 6 · READING CVS WITH AI

~~Paid AI screening tools~~

↓

# Ollama + Open WebUI

open source ★ 186,016 stars

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ An AI model running on your own laptop
- ✓ Upload CVs and the job description, ask for a summary against the role
- ✓ Candidate data never leaves your machine

THE CATCH

You need a recent laptop with plenty of memory. Smaller models run fine, big ones crawl.

github.com/ollama/ollama · github.com/open-webui/open-webui

ONE THING TO BE CAREFUL ABOUT

# Use AI to read CVs faster. Not to reject people.

- If the role is in New York City, automated screening tools need a yearly independent bias audit by law.
- The EU AI Act lists AI screening of job applicants as high-risk.
- Have a person make every no.

## THE WHOLE STACK

Applicant tracking
**Frappe HR** instead of Greenhouse

Interview scheduling
**Cal.com** instead of Calendly

Video interviews
**Jitsi Meet** instead of Zoom

Application forms
**Formbricks** instead of Typeform

Offer letters
**Documenso** instead of DocuSign

Reading CVs with AI
**Ollama + Open WebUI** instead of AI screening tools

# Save this for your next hire.

Repo links are in the first comment. I post one free tool most days on this page.

What's in your hiring stack?